

ACME CLOUD EMPLOYEE HANDBOOK

Welcome to Acme Cloud

This handbook is a general reference for Acme Cloud employees covering conduct, working norms, time off, expenses, and basic security practices. It supplements, and does not replace, your offer letter and any country-specific addenda provided by People Operations.

Our mission is to help engineering teams ship reliable software faster, and to run the infrastructure behind that promise responsibly.

Our values:

- Default to transparency internally.
- Prefer reversible decisions and iterate quickly.
- Treat production stability as a shared responsibility.
- Assume good intent, and say so directly when something is wrong.

Code of Conduct

Acme Cloud is committed to providing a respectful, harassment-free work environment for everyone, regardless of background, identity, or role.

Expected behavior includes:

- Treating colleagues, customers, and candidates with respect.
- Giving and receiving feedback constructively.
- Escalating concerns rather than letting them fester.

Unacceptable behavior includes harassment, discrimination, retaliation against someone who raises a concern in good faith, and misuse of company systems or customer data for personal purposes.

Report concerns to your manager, any People Operations partner, or through the confidential ethics reporting line linked on the internal People Operations portal. Reports are treated confidentially to the extent possible and retaliation is itself a policy violation.

Working Hours and Remote Work

Acme Cloud is a remote-friendly company. Most teams operate with flexible hours built around a few hours of core overlap with their immediate team, agreed upon locally.

Employees are expected to:

- Keep their calendar reasonably current for their team's time zone.
- Attend scheduled synchronous meetings for their team.
- Be reachable during their team's agreed core hours.

On-call engineering roles have additional availability expectations during their rotation; see `production-runbook.txt` for on-call specifics, which take precedence over general working-hours guidance during an active rotation.

Paid Time Off

Acme Cloud offers a flexible paid-time-off program rather than a fixed annual allotment. Employees are encouraged to take at least three consecutive weeks off per year, in addition to shorter breaks.

To request time off:

1. Discuss timing with your manager, especially around planned product launches or known on-call commitments.
2. Log the time off in the People Operations portal.
3. Set an out-of-office message and hand off any time-sensitive work before you leave.

Time off does not need to be justified beyond normal team planning. Manager approval exists to coordinate coverage, not to gatekeep rest.

Expense Reimbursement

Reasonable business expenses are reimbursed through the expense portal. Common reimbursable categories include conference travel approved in advance, a home-office equipment stipend, and team-building activities within budget guidelines set by your manager.

Submit expenses within 60 days of the purchase, with a receipt attached for any single expense over \$25. Expenses submitted without a receipt above that threshold may be rejected.

Questions about whether something is reimbursable should be asked before the purchase, not after, by messaging #finance-help.

Security Basics for All Employees

Every employee, not just engineers, plays a role in keeping Acme Cloud and customer data secure.

Baseline expectations:

- Use the company password manager for work credentials.
- Enroll in multi-factor authentication (MFA) for your company account as soon as you receive IT provisioning instructions.
- Never share your credentials or MFA codes with anyone, including IT staff, who should never ask for them.
- Report lost devices to #it-helpdesk immediately.

Employees with production system access are additionally subject to the `access-control-policy.md` requirements, including mandatory MFA for production access and membership in the `production-engineers` group. Those requirements are enforced separately from, and in addition to, the baseline expectations on this page.

IT and Equipment

New employees receive a laptop and any role-specific equipment before their start date wherever possible. Equipment remains company property and must be returned upon departure.

Report hardware issues, access requests, and software install requests through the #it-helpdesk channel or the IT portal.

Closing note

This handbook is reviewed periodically by People Operations. Policies not covered here, including compensation and equity program details, are documented separately and shared directly with employees by People Operations and Finance.